SERVANT
LEADERSHIP STORIES

STORIES ON BUILDING TRUST, RADICAL EMPATHY, & ELITE TEAMS
TAKE CARE OF YOUR PEOPLE

In many organizations, there is a dangerous distance between the staff front office and the making or shop floor workforce. Many leaders believe they can command from a distance, but the result is often a "silent tax": the erosion of trust, the growth of bureaucracy, and the death of innovation.

Servant Leadership Stories is a field guide for the leader who isn't afraid to get their boots dirty. Through these gritty, fast-paced stories, Dr. Tom DePaoli takes you from the production floors of paper mills to the midnight tarmac of Naval Air Stations to reveal the unfiltered truth about what it takes to earn "Street Cred" and drive a real organizational transformation.

Within these pages, you will discover:

- **The Power of the Handshake:** Why personal integrity and mutual respect will always outperform a hundred-page legal contract.
- **The Reverse Apprentice:** Why the smartest move a leader can make is becoming a student of their own employees.
- **Slaying the Bureaucracy Dragon:** How to use simple Kaizen tools to untangle "spaghetti" processes and eliminate waste.
- **Radical Empathy:** Moving beyond adversarial "win-lose" tactics to achieve deep, information-based breakthroughs in negotiations.

Whether you are "bootstrapping" a department turnaround or looking to gain a foothold in your career, these battle-tested lessons provide a roadmap to excellence. It's time to stop admiring the problem from the "command shack or ivory tower." It's time to walk the process, respect the sweat, and lead from the front.

Stop managing by the manual. Start leading with Street Cred.



BY DR. TOM DEPAOLI, THOMAS DEPAOLI

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